PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE (9–1) HISTORY MARK SCHEME

Best Guess Mock Exam 9: Peaceful Protests and their Impact (1963–65)

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75 (1HI0/33)

Question 1: Inference from Source A (4 Marks)

Target: AO3 (4 marks). Award 1 mark for each valid inference, up to 2. Award 1 mark for each corresponding quote/detail, up to 2.

Sample Acceptable Inferences (the dangers faced by civil rights volunteers during the Freedom Summer in Mississippi in 1964):

• **Inference 1:** Civil rights volunteers lived in constant terror of violent white supremacist attacks.
- *Detail from source:* "We are told never to stand near windows at night and to always check our cars before starting the engines. Everyone is terrified after the disappearance of the three boys..."

• **Inference 2:** The commitment of local Black families encouraged volunteers to persevere despite lethal risks.
- *Detail from source:* "seeing the courage of the local black families who still show up to our Freedom Schools makes me determined not to leave."

Question 2: Causal Explanation (12 Marks)

> **Target:** AO1/AO2 (12 marks). Level 4 (10–12 marks): An analytical explanation showing a line of reasoning with clear links to the outcome, supported by accurate, detailed knowledge.

"One reason why the campaign in Selma (1965) was successful was Martin Luther King Jr.'s strategic choice of location to deliberately provoke a violent reaction." The SCLC intentionally chose Selma because of its notoriously aggressive local sheriff, Jim Clark, and its appealing voter registration record (where only 383 of 15,000 eligible Black adults were registered). King knew that peaceful marchers demanding the vote would be met with unwarranted police brutality. *Therefore, this strategic provocation led to success because it guaranteed that the oppressive reality of Southern voter suppression could no longer be hidden from the rest of the nation.*

"Another reason for its success was the immense power of television media in shocking the national public." During the first attempted march to Montgomery on 7 March 1965, peaceful demonstrators were viciously attacked with tear gas, whips, and clubs by state troopers on the **Edmund Pettus Bridge**. This event became known as **Bloody Sunday**. The unprovoked savagery was broadcast directly into millions of living rooms across America and around the world. *Therefore, the campaign succeeded because the horrific visual evidence generated massive national sympathy and outrage, transforming a local Alabama protest into an urgent national political crisis.*

"A final reason the campaign was successful was that it forced immediate and decisive federal intervention." In the wake of the public outcry over Bloody Sunday, President **Lyndon B. Johnson** federalised the National Guard to protect the marchers so they could successfully complete their journey to Montgomery. More importantly, Johnson used the momentum of the crisis to demand that Congress pass new legislation. *Therefore, the campaign ultimately succeeded because it gave LBJ the exact political leverage he needed to sign the historic **Voting Rights Act of 1965**, which banned literacy tests and finally guaranteed the vote for Black Americans.*

In conclusion, the Selma campaign was successful because the calculated bravery of the marchers created a violent media spectacle, which in turn left the federal government with no choice but to forcefully intervene and change the law.

Question 3(a): Source Utility (8 Marks)

Target: AO3 (8 marks). Assess content utility, verify with contextual knowledge, and evaluate provenance reliability and limitations for BOTH sources.

Source B is highly useful for explaining the political and moral pressure on the federal government to introduce the Voting Rights Act of 1965. President Johnson explicitly compares the crisis at Selma to historic turning points like "Lexington and Concord," declaring it "deadly wrong" to deny Black citizens the right to vote. This content is highly useful because it is supported by my knowledge that the violence in Selma shocked the nation, giving Johnson the political mandate to introduce the Voting Rights Act and deliver his famous "We Shall Overcome" speech to Congress in March 1965, which confirms that the address represents the official federal commitment to intervene. The provenance of an address to a joint session of Congress on 15 March 1965 makes the source extremely useful because it captures the direct legislative reaction of the presidency at the absolute peak of the Selma crisis. However, it is limited because it presents Johnson's actions as a purely moral decision, downplaying his administration's earlier political reluctance to introduce voting rights legislation until forced by grassroots pressure.

Source C is highly useful for showing the immediate, violent catalyst that forced the federal government to act. John Lewis describes how state troopers attacked peaceful marchers on the "Edmund Pettus Bridge" with "tear gas" and "clubs," and notes that the televised brutality "shocked the conscience of the nation." This content's utility is supported by my knowledge that the events of "Bloody Sunday" on 7 March 1965 were broadcast to millions of American homes, generating widespread moral outrage and prompting national protests, which directly forced President Johnson to federalise the National Guard and demand immediate voting rights legislation. The provenance of a first-hand autobiography by John Lewis, who led the march and was beaten on the bridge, makes the source highly useful by providing an authentic, inside perspective of the tactical discipline and physical sacrifices of the activists. However, because it was written decades later in 1998, it represents a polished, retrospective narrative of the event's historic significance rather than a raw, unfiltered record of the immediate tactical decisions of the marchers.

Question 3(b): Difference Between Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Identify the main difference of view, supported by details from both interpretations.

The main difference is that Interpretation 1 argues that the landmark civil rights laws were a **"triumph of presidential leadership"** achieved through Johnson's political skill. In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that the legislation was a **"prize won through the blood and courage of the grassroots movement"** which forced reluctant presidents to act.

Question 3(c): Reason for Difference in Interpretations (4 Marks)

Target: AO4 (4 marks). Explain how the historians may have relied on different sources to reach their views.

The interpretations differ because the historians have given weight to different sources. Interpretation 1 is supported by Source B, which show President Johnson taking command in his speech and declaring that it is "deadly wrong" to deny the vote, leading to the view that the laws were a **"triumph of presidential leadership"**. Conversely, Interpretation 2 is supported by Source C, which details how the grassroots marchers faced police brutality on the bridge to "shock the conscience of the nation", leading to the view that the legislation was a **"prize won through the blood and courage of the grassroots movement"**.

Question 3(d): Evaluation of Interpretation (16 Marks + 4 SPaG)

Target: AO4 (16 marks) + SPaG (4 marks). Level 4 (13–16 marks): Balanced discussion analyzing both interpretations with sustained contextual knowledge, leading to a justified judgment.

I agree to a large extent with Interpretation 1 because President Johnson's political skill was essential to get the bills passed through a divided Congress. The interpretation argues that the laws were a "triumph of presidential leadership" due to "President Johnson's masterful political skills". From my own knowledge, I know this to be accurate; Johnson was a veteran Southern politician from Texas who knew exactly how to bully and persuade opposing politicians. When Dixiecrat politicians attempted to block the 1964 Civil Rights Act using a filibuster, it was LBJ's political mastery that gathered enough Republican support to break it. Furthermore, LBJ brilliantly manipulated "Kennedy's tragic legacy" by explicitly telling Congress that passing the 1964 Act was the only way to truly honour the assassinated president's memory, as shown in Source B's focus on the moral authority of the presidency. This supports Interpretation 1's view that these acts were a **"triumph of presidential leadership"** due to Johnson's **"masterful political skills"**.

However, Interpretation 2 is more convincing in highlighting that both Kennedy and Johnson were forced into action by the grassroots civil rights movement. Interpretation 1 focuses purely on presidential leadership, but from my own knowledge, neither president proactively introduced these bills without being pressured by extreme crises. President Kennedy only proposed the Civil Rights Bill in 1963 because the global embarrassment of police dogs attacking children in Birmingham left him no choice. Similarly, President Johnson only introduced the Voting Rights Act of 1965 as a direct reaction to the events in Selma. As Lewis describes in Source C, activists deliberately provoked the violence of **Bloody Sunday** on the **Edmund Pettus Bridge** because they knew televised police brutality was the only way to force LBJ's hand. Therefore, the true catalyst for the legislation was not presidential initiative, but the blood and bravery of ordinary Black Americans who made the status quo politically impossible to maintain, supporting Interpretation 2's view that it was a **"prize won through the blood and courage of the grassroots movement"**.

In conclusion, while I agree with Interpretation 1 that the actual passage of the acts required the formidable legislative skills of President Johnson, the interpretation gives too much credit to the White House. The presidents were reactors, not initiators; they only wielded their political power to pass the Civil Rights and Voting Rights Acts because the unrelenting courage of the grassroots civil rights movement forced them to do so.